

BANARAS HINDU UNIVERSITY

B.Com. (Hons.) — Semester I Examination, 2016-17

Paper No. BCH-E-111: English Language

Time: 3 Hours

Maximum Marks: 70

Instructions: The figures on the right indicate full marks for the concerned question. Answer all Sections.

SECTION – A

Question 1. Answer any **two** of the following: [2 × 10 = 20]

- (a) Your employer, Ratan Tata of Tata and Sons (Bombay, House 24, Homi Mody Street, Mumbai 400001, India), wishes to have information about a new photocopier he has seen advertised in *Business World*. You are Rohit Bhargava. Write a letter to the Manager, Canon India (425/1, Robert Street, New Delhi), asking for details of the XR66 Photocopier Machine. It is most important that the copier they buy is able to reduce and enlarge easily. A demonstration would be appreciated if this is possible.
- (b) Write a “letter of reply” in response to the letter mentioned in Question 1(a) above.
- (c) Write a letter from the Purchasing Manager, Singh Furniture (92, Godowlia, Varanasi) to the Sales Manager of Saraswati Timber Ltd. (231/1, St. Ann Street, Chennai) complaining about the quality of the last delivery of teak finish wood they bought from the firm. Mention that in the past the quality of goods has always been very good, but if the quality is not up to the required standard, the firm will have to look elsewhere for a supplier.
- (d) For almost a month your hostel has been facing an acute shortage of power supply. Write a letter to the Chief Warden, making her aware of the situation and requesting the proper restoration of electricity so as to ensure the smooth conduct of academic activities.

OR

Write a letter to your employer regretfully tendering your resignation on health grounds. Say that you are deeply sorry to have to leave after 15 years’ connection with the company, but your decision has been made after much careful thought. Include in your letter an appreciation for the help and kindness shown by your seniors, and also how you have enjoyed the pleasant working relationship with your colleagues. [20]

SECTION – B

Question 2. Write a précis for the following paragraph in not more than 65 words and give it an appropriate title: [10]

Today there are 3000 million people in the world. Fifty years ago only 2000 million people lived in it. If earth’s population were evenly distributed over its land surface, there would be about 550 persons to the square mile. But the earth has vast areas of forest, mountains and desert that are almost totally uninhabited. On the other hand, it has great cities with millions of people living in a few square miles.

To feed the fast growing population of our earth, scientists and planners have to discover new ways to produce more. One possible way is to bring more land under cultivation. This can be done only in places where there is a lot of land not used for productive purposes. In many places this is no longer possible as all the arable land is already cultivated. A second way is to make use of new types of seeds to produce more. Already a number of new strains of paddy and wheat have been developed in different parts of the world. India is one of the countries where a lot of useful work has been done in the field of agricultural research.

Question 4. Answer the following questions as per the instructions in the brackets: [10 × 1 = 10]

- (a) A dog bit the old man. (*Change the Voice*)
- (b) I _____ (see) the Taj Mahal. I _____ (see) it last year. (*Fill in the blanks with the correct tense forms (Present Perfect or Past Simple) of the verbs given in the brackets.*)
- (c) Gold is _____ precious metal. (*Use suitable article*)
- (d) London is on _____ Thames. (*Use suitable article*)
- (e) I prefer to read _____ the library. (*Use suitable preposition*)
- (f) Those were the days _____ you could buy a bicycle for just thirty five rupees. (*Use suitable relative pronoun or relative adverb*)
- (g) It is normal for a worker to ask for a holiday once a year. _____, workers are allowed a holiday once every year. (*Fill in the blank with appropriate form of the italicized word "normal"*)
- (h) The doctor gave him two different medicines. The _____ between the two was not noticeable. (*Fill in the blank with appropriate form of the italicized word "different"*)
- (i) He appears to be honest and intelligent. But _____, as we all know, can be deceptive. (*Fill in the blank with appropriate form of the italicized word "appears"*)
- (j) If the weather _____ (permits, permitted, had permitted) we shall play the match on Sunday. (*Use correct tense form of the verb*)

Question 5. Explain briefly (approximately 200 words each), with proper reference and context, the below quoted lines from your textbook *Current English for Language Skills*: [2 × 5 = 10]

- (a) "And the real way to understand this story is not merely to read about it in other people's books but to go to the Book of Nature itself. You will, I hope, soon begin to learn how to read this story from the rocks and mountains. Imagine how fascinating it is: every little stone that you see lying in the road or on the mountain side may be a little page in nature's book and may be able to tell you something if you only know how to read it."

OR

"I supposed that if Luz Long won, it would add some new support to Hitler's Aryan-superiority theory. Anxious about Hitler's ways, I determined to go out there and basically show Der Fuhrer and his master race who was superior and who wasn't."

- (b) “A lily of a day
Is fairer far in May,
Although it fall and die that night—
It was the plant and flower of light.
In small proportions we just beauties see;
And in short measures life may perfect be.”
“Even thus last night, and two nights more I lay,
And could not win thee, Sleep! by any stealth:
So do not let me wear tonight away:”

OR

SECTION – C

Question 6. Answer any **five** of the following questions each in a sentence or two: $[5 \times 2 = 10]$

- (a) What is the full title of William Wordsworth’s poem prescribed in your course?
- (b) “If a little pebble can tell you so much, how much more could we learn from all the rocks and mountains and the many other things we see around us?” Who is speaking to whom in these lines?
- (c) Who are the editors of your textbook *Current English for Language Skills*?
- (d) Who is the author of “My Greatest Olympic Prize”?
- (e) What is the full title of Ben Jonson’s poem prescribed in your course?
- (f) Who was Jesse Owens’ rival in the Summer Olympics of 1936?
- (g) On whose life is the chapter “My Struggle For An Education” based?